

3 myths keeping small businesses **out** of federal.

01

OF FIVE

THE MYTH

~~You need federal past performance before you can win anything.~~

WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE

Teaming agreements let new entrants piggyback on a prime's record. You can sub on day one, build a real track record, and bid as a prime within 2–3 years.

02

OF FIVE

THE MYTH

Once you get a GSA Schedule, agencies will find you and award you work.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE

The Schedule is access — not a sales engine. You still need to market, respond to RFQs, and follow up. Holders who go passive almost always end up with zero awards.

03

OF FIVE

THE MYTH

Getting a GSA Schedule costs more than a small business can afford.

WHAT'S ACTUALLY TRUE

There's no application fee. The real cost is 100+ hours of paperwork — or hiring someone to handle it. Most holders recoup that investment on their first award.

YOUR TURN

Which myth held you back?

Drop the belief that almost kept you from pursuing federal contracting.